Frequently Asked Questions (FAQs)

Timeline & Duration

Q: What is the overall schedule for the hackathon and how long is each part?
A: The **Campus Beats Case Challenge** consists of two back-to-back parts that together last up to *approximately* 90 minutes. The active working time is 90 minutes, divided into two rounds: a 60-minute Team Case Study round and a 30-minute Individual Quiz round.
The **Campus Beats Tech Challenge** consists of two back-to-back parts that together last up to *approximately* 110 minutes. The active working time is 110 minutes, divided into two rounds: a 60-minute Team tech challenge round and a 50-minute Individual Quiz round.
The entire process is expected to be completed in one sitting.

Q: When can we access the problem statement, and do we need to start exactly at 11:00 AM?
A: The hackathon **opens at 11:00 AM**, but you do **not** have to start at exactly 11:00. You can choose any convenient start time between 11:00 AM and (at the latest) around 6:00 PM on the scheduled day. The problem statement and data will become visible only **after you start the round**, and the clock will run continuously from that point. *You should plan to start when your team is ready to focus without interruption.* If you open the problem statement before you're ready to work, it will still count as your official start and the timer will begin. So, use the window from 11:00–6:00 to coordinate with your team and start when all members are prepared. You **cannot start after ~6:00 PM** if you want the full time, since the platform will close at 8:00 PM for everyone.

Q: Do I have to take the Individual Quiz at the exact same time as my teammates, and do we all have 30 minutes each?
A: Each team member has their own individual quiz. The individual rounds are typically taken **simultaneously** (for efficiency, especially if your team finishes the group case/tech problem statement close to the deadline). Once your team finishes the group case/tech problem statement, each member will launch their individual assessment (either via a link or directly on the platform).

Team Participation & Login Rules

Q: Does every team member need to log in for solving the Team based problem statement, or can one person represent the team?
A: For the **Team based problem statement, only one team member (preferably the Team Leader) log in and start the challenge on the platform.** In fact, we recommend that **only one device/session per team** should actively input answers for the group assessment round. All team members will collaborate on the solution, but having multiple team members trying to separately open or answer in the platform could cause confusion or technical conflicts. So, decide in advance which member will be typing in the answers (and have that person start the hackaton for your team). The other team members do **not** need to log into the platform during the team round; they can contribute by discussing and helping solve the problems without each opening the platform on their own computer.

Q: Can our team members participate from different locations, or do we all need to be in the same place?
A: You may choose to collaborate **either in the same physical location or from different locations**, whatever works best for your team. There is **no requirement to be co-located**. If you are in the same room, you can all work together on one device (or look at a shared screen) and discuss freely in person. If you are in **different locations**, you are allowed to communicate via a conference call (video call, phone call, etc.) during the team round so that everyone can discuss the problem statement. Just remember that only the team captain should operate the platform to enter answers. Whether together or remote, make sure to coordinate your start time so everyone is ready and the full team can contribute during the solving window.

Q: What if one of our team members can't join or is running late?
A: We strongly encourage **all team members to participate** in both rounds. The team round is designed for collaborative problem-solving, so missing a member could put your team at a disadvantage. Likewise, every member should complete the individual quiz portion to maximize your team's chances. It's best to choose a start time when **everyone can be present** for the full duration.

Q: Can we use external tools, like Excel for calculations or our own reference materials, during the hackathon?
A: No external software or materials should be used during the timed rounds. The hackathon platform is browser-based and will likely restrict you from switching windows or accessing other applications on the device that's running the test. All the information you need to solve the problem statement will be provided within the platform (via the data given and the AI assistant). Copying data out of the platform (for example, taking photos or screenshots of the data, or trying to export it to Excel) is **not allowed** and may be considered a rules violation. Trust that the problem statement is designed to be solved with the resources on the platform and your team's brainstorming – you won't need any outside software or pre-made reference materials.

Q: How can we navigate or answer the questions? Can we answer them in any order and go back to previous questions?
A: The platform will present the problem statement and its questions in a structured way. You should be able to navigate between the different questions or sections of the problem statement within the 60-minute window. You can answer the questions in any order you prefer, and you can revise your answers before the time is up. Just be sure to manage your time well to address all parts of the problem statement. All answers should be finalized in the platform when your time is over. Once the time is finished or submitted, you will not be able to change those answers.

Individual Assessment (Quiz) Round

Q: How do we access and complete the individual quiz?
A: After your team finishes the group assessment segment each member should proceed with their **individual quiz**. All candidates can access the Individual Quiz on their Superset dashboard. Each team member should log into the hackathon platform using their own credentials to take the quiz. All team members typically should begin their individual tests as soon as the team round concludes. **Each quiz is taken on a separate device by each team member.** The quizzes can be taken simultaneously in parallel – there's no need to take turns. The quiz interface will guide you through submitting your answers, and it will auto-submit once time is up.

Q: Are the quiz questions the same for every team member, or do they differ?
A: The **general format and topics** of the individual quiz are the same for everyone, but the **specific questions might not be identical for all participants.** The system may draw questions from a question bank, so your questions could be different from your teammates'. This is to ensure the integrity of the individual assessment. Rest assured that all quizzes are calibrated to have similar difficulty and coverage (for example, everyone will get questions covering data interpretation, logical reasoning, etc., even if the exact questions vary). **No collaboration is allowed during this individual round**—each team member must complete their own quiz independently.

Q: Will my performance on the individual quiz affect our team's chances?
A: Yes. While the overall team performance is very important, your individual quiz performance also plays a role in the overall evaluation. All team members are expected to complete the quiz, and those scores may be considered in the team's final ranking or as a qualifying criterion. This ensures that each team member has a solid foundation of skills. We recommend that everyone takes the individual round seriously. If an individual does not perform well or fails to participate, it could impact the team's progression or that individual's eligibility for personal opportunities offered through the hackathon.

AI & Prompt Engineering Usage

Q: What is the "prompt engineering" or AI component of the hackathon, and how do we use the provided AI tool? (Not applicable for Tech Challenge)
A: The platform features an integrated AI assistant that your team can use during the Case Challenge. (Not applicable for Tech Challenge). This is essentially a chat-based **AI tool that has access to the case data and background information.** You can type natural-language questions to this AI (this is what we mean by "prompt engineering") to retrieve data, get clarifications, or even solicit analytical insights that might help with your case. For example, you might ask it to provide a summary of a dataset, explain a trend, or give you specific figures you need for your calculations. The AI will respond with information or data if it's available. Using this AI effectively—by asking clear, strategic questions—is part of the case challenge. There is **no separate window or setup needed**; it's built into the case platform.

Q: Can we use other external AI tools or resources, like ChatGPT, web search, or personal software, to help during the hackathon? (Not applicable for Tech Challenge)
A: No, external tools are not allowed during the live rounds. The hackathon is proctored and the system may flag or disqualify participants for navigating away from the platform or using unapproved software. You should **not use external AI services (e.g., ChatGPT on another browser tab)**, and similarly do not use external websites or software (like Google, Wikipedia, Excel, etc.) during the timed rounds.

Q: Can we have the AI do the analysis or write the answers for us? (Not applicable for Tech Challenge)
A: The AI assistant is there to help you **retrieve and understand information** from the case materials quickly, not to replace your problem-solving. You should not rely on it to generate your entire answer. In fact, the AI's knowledge is limited to the data provided in the case and general concepts – it may not automatically know the best solution or might sometimes give incomplete answers. You still need to interpret the information, make decisions, and formulate your team's conclusions. Use the AI for things like looking up specific data points, checking assumptions, or getting initial insights. The final answers should reflect **your team's understanding** and be written in your own words. Remember, the judges want to see *your* analytical thinking and approach to the problem.

Proctoring & Compliance

Q: What are the proctoring rules for this hackathon? Are both video and audio being monitored?
A: Yes. The **Digital Analytics Challenge** is a **fully proctored online hackathon.** This means that when you participate, you will need to enable your **webcam (video)**, and possibly your **microphone**, for the duration of the challenge. The platform (Superset or the hackathon interface) will monitor for any unusual activities. It can detect if you try to switch windows/tabs or use other applications during the test. It may also capture audio and video to ensure integrity. Assume that everything you do on the hackathon device is being monitored or recorded. You'll likely need to grant the platform permission to use your camera mic before starting. Both the team assessment and the individual quiz are proctored events, so maintain exam-like conditions: **don't use phones or additional devices** and avoid any behavior that could be perceived as cheating.

Q: What actions could cause disqualification or be flagged during the proctored session?
A: Activities that violate the hackathon rules or suggest cheating will be flagged by the system or proctors. These include:

- **Switching browser tabs/windows or using other applications** on the computer running the hackathon. (For example, opening a new browser tab to search the web, or using other software, will trigger alerts. Do **not** alt-tab or leave the test window during the challenge.)
- **Looking off-screen frequently or having long unexplained absences from the camera.** If you need to step away for an urgent reason, be aware this will be noted by proctors.
- **Receiving help from anyone outside your team.** Only registered team members should be involved in solving the problem statement.

Q: If we experience technical problems (e.g., internet disconnects or the platform freezes), what should we do?
A: In the event of a technical issue, **don't panic**. If possible, **rejoin the platform or refresh** the page as quickly as you can. The platform is designed to save your progress periodically, so you should be able to continue where you left off, but the timer will likely continue running during any disconnection. Unfortunately, we **cannot extend the timer for individual technical difficulties**, so it's important to have a stable internet connection during the hackathon. We also suggest closing any unnecessary applications to help your computer run smoothly and ensuring you have a backup internet source if available. If the platform itself has a widespread outage or you encounter a serious issue that prevents you from completing the challenge, **notify the ZS team immediately** (use the provided support contact or helpline). In general, though, plan as if **no retakes or pauses will be possible**, and control what you can: test your system beforehand, ensure your camera and mic work, and have a reliable internet connection for the duration of the event.

Q: Are we being audio-recorded, and should we worry about multiple voices (or noise) during the team round?
A: The proctoring system may record audio, but as noted, multiple voices from team members collaborating is expected and is not against the rules. That said, try to find a quiet environment for your team. If you're in the same room, background noise or all talking at once might make it hard for a proctor to follow what's happening, but it won't be treated as misconduct if it's clearly team discussion. If you are on a conference call, use headsets if possible to avoid echo (and mute yourself when not speaking) – this will keep the audio clear for the proctoring. Essentially, **focus on the hackathon and don't worry – we want you to collaborate as a team.** The recording is there to deter and review any cheating, not to penalize legitimate teamwork.

Submission Format & Deliverables

Q: How do we submit our answers for the case study round? Where do we upload our solutions or files? (Not applicable for Tech Challenge)
A: There is **no separate file upload required for the team.** The hackathon platform itself will have text boxes (the "workpad") for each question in the case. Your team's designated typist (e.g. team leader) should input the answers there and save or submit them through the platform. Those responses constitute your team's official submission for the case round. Once you've answered all parts of the case to the best of your ability, you will either click a **Submit/End** button or the system will automatically capture your answers when time is up. The judges will review what you've written in the platform. There is no need to prepare additional documentation during the challenge.

Q: What about the individual quiz – how are answers submitted there?
A: The individual assessment is conducted on the platform as a standard online quiz. You'll select or input your answers within the quiz interface (for example, choosing the correct option for multiple-choice questions, or typing short responses where applicable). All responses are automatically saved and submitted through the system. As with the group assessment round, there's no separate file or document you need to upload for the quiz – just complete all the questions in the online form and submit when finished (or it will auto-submit when time expires).

Evaluation & Weightage

Q: If one or two team members perform poorly on the individual quiz, can that prevent our team from advancing?
A: The hackathon is designed to evaluate both teamwork and individual skills. If a team's performance is excellent but one member's individual score is very low, it may affect the team's overall evaluation. In many cases, hackathons require all team members to meet a basic threshold in the individual round. While an outstanding team submission can help offset some weaknesses, **every member should strive to do well on the quiz**. Conversely, even if all individuals score perfectly on the quiz, a weak team submission could still eliminate the team. This ensures both the team and all individuals demonstrate their capabilities.

Q: Is there any advantage to submitting the solutions early?
A: No, there is no extra credit for finishing early. You should use the available time to refine and check your answers. The hackathon is scored based on the quality and accuracy of your responses, not how fast you submit. As long as you submit before the time is up, you will get full credit for your work. We recommend using any remaining time to double-check your answers or add details rather than rushing to finish early. That said, be sure you **do submit on time** – late submissions might not be accepted by the system.
